Wandering Voices: Exploring Europe's Archaeological Paths on Paper

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The travel narrative emerged as a particularly popular literary genre in the 19th century, driven by advancements in transportation and the rise of tourism, which facilitated the international mobility of cultural elites. This phenomenon generated an extensive corpus of literature that not only documented individual experiences but also reflected the cultural and political dynamics of the period. However, Latin American authors' narratives, mainly women's, have often been relegated to the margins. From a historiographical perspective, there has traditionally been a focus on colonial chronicles and accounts of scientific or commercial expeditions written by European male explorers. In contrast, works by female authors have received significantly less scholarly attention (Barco Cebrián 2018; Miseres 2017; Spicer-Scalante 2012). In recent years, however, this trend has started to shift. A growing number of studies have brought visibility to the role of women travellers, especially those of European upper-middle-class origins who visited exotic territories during the Enlightenment or Victorian periods (Dolan 2001; Dutta 2020; Ghose 1998; Lafarga 2012; Morató 2001; Robinson 1994; Romero 1992; Schlick 2012; Stevenson 1982). These scholarly efforts have expanded to encompass women from diverse social classes and nationalities, who travelled to diverse geographies during other historical periods (Alzate / Doll 2014; Bailey 2019; Foster / Mills 2002; Ferrús Antón 2011; Miseres 2017).

Travel books become a source of information to study cultural heritage from a chronological, spatial and emotional perspective (Abascal 2012; Besson 2021; Ooghe 2007; Salas Álvarez 2008). This paper focuses on the viewpoints of Latin American women writers (Cáceres 1911; Camarillo 1930; Carrasquilla 2011; Echeverría1937; Matto 1909) on European archaeological heritage in the early 20th century, with a particular emphasis on archaeological sites of Classical Antiquity such as *Itálica* in Spain, *Pompeii* in Italy, and *Cemenelum* in France. Adopting a perspective of otherness, it explores how these women engaged with these heritage places, the aspects that captured their attention, and the emotional resonances these encounters evoked in their writings. So, a comparative analysis between these women's accounts and contemporary archaeological knowledge provides insight into how ruins were interpreted and reimagined in Latin America, a context in which references to Classical Antiquity not only supported academic data but also shaped political discourses of independence (Aguilera Durán / Valenzuela Matus, 2024; Del Molino 2024; Laird 2010; Mills 1974; Romero Recio et al. 2023).

Methodologically, this study is framed within the REWIND project , which applies Digital Humanities tools such as semantic annotation, ontological models, sentiment analysis algorithms, and Geographic Information Systems to explore the spatiotemporal coordinates of heritage and its reception, based on decolonial gender approaches (Comino 2024). This methodological proposal follows the FAIR principles with the aim of ensuring that both the workflow and the project deliverables can be used in future research.

The REWIND dataset corresponds to the 'deep data' concept (Štular / M. Belak, 2022) since the geosemantic analysis depended on working narrowly with the text because every annotation demands interpretation. This dataset was created by encoding travel books using XML markup language and the standards proposed by the Text Encoding Initiative . On the one hand, a modernised diplomatic digital edition of each publication is produced, ensuring that not only the structure of the books is annotated, but also that the original formatting of the text (such as italics, capital letters, indentation, etc.) and any typographical errors are preserved. Additionally, the Spanish is adapted to the most recent edition of the *Ortografía de la Lengua Española* (RAE 2010), as the sentiment analysis relies on a contemporary Spanish emotion lexicon. On the other hand, tagging is used to identify people, places, objects, and events, turning each book into a database that can be queried using XQuery expressions. This annotation system allows us to differentiate all cultural heritage elements by linking them, whenever possible, with geographical coordinates through the GeoNames gazetteer and with Linked Open Data (LOD) from VIAF and Wikidata . Additionally, the ROSSIO Thesaurus was used to categorise the different European cultural heritage elements through the @type attribute according to the UNESCO typology, which differentiates between intangible cultural heritage and tangible movable and immovable cultural heritage.

Before encoding the text in XML-TEI, a reflection exercise was carried out on how to abstract the

real world when modelling it (Ore / Øyvind, 2009). Historical narrative sources are often characterised by numerous interconnected references. For this reason, the project opted for a knowledge graph based on CIDOC-CRM to structure historical information in a manner compatible with the semantic web model. So, once the text was encoded in a computer-readable format, it was possible to obtain the data relating to the elements of European cultural heritage that the authors mentioned in their travel books and integrate them into the ontological model. Thus, the <objectName> label from XML-TEI text encoding is used for elements of material cultural heritage, which corresponds to information associated with the E22 Human-Made Object class of the ontological model. And through the @type attribute, different subclasses based on the ROSSIO Thesaurus are indicated. This categorisation facilitates ontological integration and, therefore, the use of LODs thanks to URIs. Creating semantically well-structured data from various sources is a challenging task, so this information is centralised in an index that makes it possible to refer to the same cultural object in different travel books using a unique identifier (@xml:id attribute). Finally, a sentiment analysis is carried out using R programming language, the Tidytext and Syuzhet packages, and the NRC Emotion Lexicon, to detect and evaluate the emotions present in the travel book descriptions of archaeological sites.

Ultimately, this research highlights the richness and originality of these women's narratives, contributing to an understanding of the tensions and dialogues between European cultural heritage and Latin American historical memory. It contributes to constructing a polyphonic historical discourse that moves beyond including women's perspectives. Instead, it seeks to truly listen to the voices of non-European women who, through their commitment to feminism and sociocultural diversity, emerge as active agents in the historical narratives.

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